to sevenpence a dozen: the turnkey found the twine and thread.[1] Two sailors fined a shilling each had £1 1s. 4d. each to pay the clerk of the peace, besides the gaoler's fees.

An elegant shirehall is now finished: may it not be hoped that the gentlemen will turn their thoughts to this crowded, offensive, and destructive gaol, especially the proprietor, who (in 1782) liberally subscribed £1000 to encourage seamen to enter into his Majesty's fleet; and who possesses an estate to uphold this prison?

PLYMOUTH TOWN GAOL

Three rooms for felons, etc., and two rooms over them for debtors. One of the former, the clink, fifteen feet by eight feet three inches, and about five and a half feet high, with a wicket in the door seven inches by five to admit light and air. To this, as I was informed, three men who were confined nearly two months under sentence of transportation, came by turns for breath. The door had not been opened for five weeks when I with difficulty entered to see a pale inhabitant. He had been there ten weeks under sentence of transportation, and said he had much rather have been hanged than confined in that noisome cell. In another room (thirteen feet by five and a half and six feet nine inches high, the window only eighteen inches by fourteen, and the wall two feet eight inches thick), at my last visit there were two prisoners; one of whom assured me he had been there upwards of seven weeks, and sometimes, with four or five other prisoners, where they were almost suffocated. The other room is for women (seventeen feet by ten). The whole is dirty, and has not been whitewashed for many years. No court: no water. The gaolers live distant; they are the three sergeants at mace. Fees, 15s. 4d., no table. Allowance to debtors, none but on application: felons, twopennyworth of bread a day. No straw.

[1] This art is very soon learnt, and when the prisoners were thus employed, I found them cheerful and healthy; they said they earned from three-halfpence to twopence a day each, with which they got a little milk or beer to their bread; and the old keeper said "it kept them out of mischief."

CORNWALL

COUNTY GAOL AT LAUNCESTON FOR FELONS

This gaol, though built in the large green belonging to the old ruinous castle, is very small; house and court measuring only fifty-two feet by forty-four; and the house not covering half that ground. The prison is a room or passage twenty-three and a half feet by seven and a half, with only one window two feet by one and a half: and three dungeons or cages on the side opposite the window: these are about six and a half feet deep; one nine feet long; one about eight; one not five: this last for women. They were all very offensive. No chimney: no water: no sewers: damp earth floors: no infirmary. The court not secure; and prisoners seldom permitted to go out to it. Indeed the whole prison is out of repair, and yet the gaoler lives distant. I once found the prisoners chained two or three together. Their provision was put down to them through a hole (nine inches by eight) in the floor of the room above (used as a chapel); and those who served them there, often caught the fatal fever. At my first visit I found the keeper, his assistant, and all the prisoners but one (an old soldier) sick of it: and heard that a few years before, many prisoners had died of it; and the keeper and his wife in one night.

COUNTY GAOL AT BODMIN

This new gaol is built on a fine eminence, at a little distance from the town, where there is a constant current of water. Here is a good house for the gaoler, in which there are apartments for master's-side debtors, and a chapel. There are separate rooms and courts for each sex of debtors, of felons, and of petty offenders or bridewell prisoners; and each prisoner has a separate lodging-room (about eight feet two inches by five feet eight, and seven and a half feet high), which is furnished with a bedstead, straw-bed, two blankets and a coverlet. There are two rooms for an infirmary, and under them three condemned cells. In two of the courts are baths. In the centre of the gaoler's house there is a turret with an alarm-bell and clock. The men who are confined for petty offences, are employed in sawing and polishing stone, and, as they have the county